

module in the machinery – perhaps the ultimate sign of acknowledging the “self” – that ends up wanting to destroy mankind.

The story is remarkably similar in *The Matrix*, where a robot named B166ER is about to be deactivated and instead kills his master. The self-awareness of the android is exposed when it stands for trial and when asked for a reason, it says, “I did not want to die.” The judge orders sentient machines to be destroyed, following which there’s a robotic uprising.

Perhaps the only famous work in science fiction to explore the concept of self-awareness without it being causal was the aforementioned Asimov story *...Thou that art mindful of him*. The two George robots reach a self-awareness not based on a need for self-preservation. Yet, the eventual conclusion of their deliberations remains in sync with that of alarmist AI theories: the destruction of mankind. 